

DEFRA / DESNZ GHG Conversion Factors 2026
Major changes report (SYNTHETIC ? for testing only)

This document summarises the most significant changes to conversion factors for the 2026 update relative to 2025.

Change: Electricity generated

The UK grid average electricity factor changed by around 9%. The 2026 update reflects a revised generation mix in the year used as the basis for the factor, together with a methodology refresh aligning transmission and distribution losses with the latest data.

Change: Diesel (average biofuel blend)

The diesel factor rose by about 6%. This reflects a reduction in the average biofuel content of forecourt diesel under the revised Renewable Transport Fuel Obligation blend for the reporting year, which raises the fossil carbon intensity per litre.

Change: Fuel oil (mineral)

The liquid fuel oil factor rose by about 7% in 2026. DEFRA relabelled this line to add the 'mineral' qualifier and refreshed the underlying carbon content of the fuel to the latest specification, which raises the kg CO₂e per litre. The rename and the value update landed together.

Change: Aluminium

Primary aluminium increased by roughly 14% following an update to the upstream electricity intensity used for smelting in the underlying life cycle inventory, reflecting a less decarbonised assumed power mix.